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Division tricks — Numbers 54 to 68

Each passage is now a mini-lesson: a challenge to hook them in, the trick, one worked example, two for the child to try, then both checked together — with encouragement all the way through. Read it like you're at the kitchen table and someone just asked "go on then, show me".

The four rules

1. Before each passage say its number clearly — "Number one", "Number two" — pause a second, read the passage, then pause a couple of seconds before the next number. Those gaps are how I find the joins. 2. Wherever you see ... leave a short beat — two seconds is plenty. Those are the "have a think" moments for the kids. 3. If you stumble, don't stop the recording: pause, say the SAME number again, and read that passage again. I'll keep your retake. 4. Kitchen-table warmth beats newsreader polish every time.

Total is roughly two hours of reading — absolutely fine to do over several sittings (each take just needs to start at a numbered item; tick them off on the printed version as you go). When done, drop the audio file(s) — m4a, mp3, wav, anything — into OneDrive Times tables/recordings and tell me.

Tick each number as you record it so you can pick up where you left off.

Part D — Division tricks

■ Say: "Number 54" — Times Tables Backwards

Quick one — what's 42 divided by 6? ... If that popped out in a flash, you already know today's secret. If it didn't, no worries — stick with me for one minute. Here's the trick: division is just multiplication flipped backwards. So instead of dividing, you ask, times what? Every division fact is a times-table fact in disguise. Let's do our question. 42 divided by 6 is really asking: 6 times what makes 42? Run through your sixes... 6 times 7 is 42. So 42 divided by 6 is 7. That's it. Your turn — pause me if you need to: what's 63 divided by 9? ... and what's 32 divided by 8? ... Have a proper go before I tell you... Right, let's check together. 63 divided by 9 asks: 9 times what makes 63? Well, 9 times 7 is 63 — so the answer is 7. And 32 divided by 8 asks: 8 times what makes 32? 8 times 4 is 32 — so the answer is 4. See? If your times tables are sharp, division is instant. You've already done the hard work — go smash the practice.

■ Say: "Number 55" — $\div 10, 100, 1000$

Quick fire — what's 350 divided by 10? ... If you said 35 before I finished asking, brilliant, you know this one. If not, you're about to learn the easiest division trick there is. To divide by 10, just take one zero off the end. To divide by 100, take two zeros off. To divide by 1000, take three off. That's really the decimal point sliding one place to the left for each zero. So, our question: 350 divided by 10. Take one zero off the end of 350... and you're left with 35. So 350 divided by 10 is 35. Your turn — pause me if you need to: what's 6200 divided by 100? ... and what's 81000 divided by 1000? ... Have a real go before I say anything... Let's check together. 6200 divided by 100: dividing by 100 means taking two zeros off. Take two zeros off 6200 and you get 62. And 81000 divided by 1000: three zeros in 1000, so take three zeros off. 81000 becomes 81. That's the whole trick — count the zeros, chop the zeros. You've got this one — go and show it off.

■ Say: "Number 56" — The 2, 5, 10 Test

Here's a challenge — without doing any dividing at all, can you tell me if 465 divides exactly by 5? ... If you spotted it straight away, you're already a detective. If not, here's the secret: you only ever need to peek at the last digit. A number divides by 2 if it ends in 0, 2, 4, 6 or 8 — that's the even numbers. It divides by 5 if it ends in 0 or 5. And it divides by 10 if it ends in 0. So, 465 — look at the last digit. It's a 5. Ends in 5 means yes, it divides by 5. No sums needed at all. Your turn — pause me if you need to: does 738 divide by 2? ... and does 890 divide by 10? ... Have a proper think before I tell you... Let's check together. 738 ends in an 8 — that's even — so yes, it divides by 2. And 890 ends in a 0 — so yes, it divides by 10. And here's a bonus: because 890 ends in 0, it divides by 2 and 5 as well. All three, from one glance. That's it — you now know a trick most grown-ups don't.

■ Say: "Number 57" — Digit Sum for 3 and 9

Try this — does 234 divide exactly by 3? No calculator, no long division. ... If you knew a sneaky way to check, take a bow. If not, here it comes. Add up the digits. If the digits add to a multiple of 3, the whole number divides by 3. And if the digits add to a multiple of 9, it divides by 9 too. Let's test 234. Add the digits: 2 plus 3 plus 4 is 9. Is 9 a multiple of 3? Yes — 3 times 3 is 9. So 234 divides by 3. Easy as that. Your turn — pause me if you need to: does 512 divide by 3? ... and does 738 divide by 9? ... Have a proper go before I spill the answers... Let's check together. For 512: 5 plus 1 plus 2 is 8. Is 8 a multiple of 3? No — so 512 does not divide by 3. And for 738: 7 plus 3 plus 8 is 18, and 18 is 9 times 2 — a multiple of 9 — so yes, 738 divides by 9. Adding a few digits beats dividing a big number every time. Go smash the practice — you've earned it.

■ **Say: "Number 58" — $\div 4 =$ Halve Twice**

Quick one — what's 84 divided by 4? ... If you got 21 in under ten seconds, you might already know this trick. If not, don't worry — it's a lovely one. Dividing by 4 in one go is hard. But 4 is just 2 times 2 — so dividing by 4 is the same as halving twice. Two easy halves instead of one tricky division. Watch it work on 84 divided by 4. Half of 84 is 42. Half of 42 is 21. So 84 divided by 4 is 21. Two little steps, done in your head. Your turn — pause me if you need to: what's 56 divided by 4? ... and what's 132 divided by 4? ... Have a proper go before I tell you... Right, let's check together. 56 divided by 4: half of 56 is 28, and half of 28 is 14. So 56 divided by 4 is 14. And 132 divided by 4: half of 132 is 66, and half of 66 is 33. So 132 divided by 4 is 33. Halve it, halve it again — that's the whole trick. See? You've got this one — go smash the practice.

■ **Say: "Number 59" — $\div 8 =$ Halve Three Times**

Here's a tough-sounding one — what's 96 divided by 8? ... If you rattled that off, hats off to you. If it made you wince, perfect — this trick is about to make it easy. 8 is 2 times 2 times 2. So dividing by 8 is just halving three times in a row. No big division — three friendly little halves. Let's take 96 divided by 8. Half of 96 is 48. Half of 48 is 24. Half of 24 is 12. So 96 divided by 8 is 12. Halve, halve, halve — done. Your turn — pause me if you need to: what's 88 divided by 8? ... and what's 240 divided by 8? ... Have a real go before I give it away... Let's check together. 88 divided by 8: half of 88 is 44, half of 44 is 22, and half of 22 is 11. So 88 divided by 8 is 11. And 240 divided by 8: half of 240 is 120, half of 120 is 60, and half of 60 is 30. So 240 divided by 8 is 30. Three quick halves beats one scary division every time. That's it — you now know a trick most grown-ups don't.

■ **Say: "Number 60" — $\div 5 = \text{Double then } \div 10$**

Quick challenge — what's 340 divided by 5? ... If you got 68 in a blink, you may already know this gem. If not, you're going to love it. Dividing by 5 feels awkward — but here's the secret: it's exactly the same as doubling the number, then dividing by 10. Why? Because one fifth is the same as two tenths. Doubling is easy, and dividing by 10 just knocks the last zero off — or slides the decimal point one place left. Let's do 340 divided by 5. Double 340: that's 680. Now divide by 10: 68. So 340 divided by 5 is 68. Your turn — pause me if you need to: what's 270 divided by 5? ... and what's 415 divided by 5? ... Have a proper go before I tell you... Let's check together. 270 divided by 5: double 270 is 540, then divide by 10 gives 54. So 270 divided by 5 is 54. And 415 divided by 5: double 415 is 830, then divide by 10 gives 83. So 415 divided by 5 is 83. Double, then chop by 10 — and you can do the two steps in either order. See? You've got this one — go smash the practice.

■ **Say: "Number 61" — Last Two for 4, Last Three for 8**

Big number alert — does 5324 divide exactly by 4? ... If you answered that without breaking a sweat, you already know the shortcut. If it looked terrifying, good news: you can ignore almost all of it. For dividing by 4, only the last two digits matter — if they divide by 4, the whole number does. For dividing by 8, only the last three digits matter. The front of the number can be as long as you like; you never touch it. So, 5324: the last two digits are 24. Does 24 divide by 4? Yes — 24 divided by 4 is 6. So the whole of 5324 divides by 4. Your turn — pause me if you need to: does 7136 divide by 4? ... and does 9240 divide by 8? ... Have a proper go before I tell you... Let's check together. 7136: last two digits are 36, and 36 divided by 4 is 9 — so yes, 7136 divides by 4. And 9240: last three digits are 240, and 240 divided by 8 is 30 — so yes, 9240 divides by 8. Huge numbers, tiny checks. That's it — you now know a trick most grown-ups don't.

■ Say: "Number 62" — Halve Both First

Quick one — what's 96 divided by 12? ... If you got 8 straight off, lovely — this trick will still speed you up. If you didn't, no worries at all, here it comes. When the number you're dividing and the number you're dividing by are both even, you can halve them both — and the answer stays exactly the same. Keep halving as long as both stay even, and a scary division turns friendly. Let's do 96 divided by 12. Both even, so halve both: 48 divided by 6. Still both even — halve again: 24 divided by 3. That's easy: 24 divided by 3 is 8. So 96 divided by 12 is 8. One warning: if there's a remainder, it got halved every time you halved, so double it back once for each halving at the end. Your turn — pause me if you need to: what's 140 divided by 20? ... and what's 180 divided by 12? ... Have a proper go before I tell you... Let's check together. 140 divided by 20: halve both to get 70 divided by 10, which is 7. And 180 divided by 12: halve both to get 90 divided by 6, halve again to get 45 divided by 3, which is 15. See? You've got this one — go smash the practice.

■ Say: "Number 63" — Split the Dividend

Big challenge this time — what's 864 divided by 6? ... If you got that in under ten seconds, you're already a division wizard. If your brain went "no chance", perfect — this trick is exactly for scary-looking sums like that. The secret: split the big number into friendly chunks that each divide easily, do the little divisions, then add the answers. Watch. 864 divided by 6: split 864 into 600 plus 264. Now, 600 divided by 6 is 100 — easy. And 264 divided by 6 is 44. Add them up: 100 plus 44 is 144. So 864 divided by 6 is 144. Two easy divisions instead of one monster. Your turn — pause me if you need to: what's 848 divided by 4? Try splitting it into 800 plus 48... And what's 396 divided by 3? Try 300 plus 96... Have a proper go... Right, together now. 848 divided by 4: 800 divided by 4 is 200, and 48 divided by 4 is 12. 200 plus 12 is 212. And 396 divided by 3: 300 divided by 3 is 100, and 96 divided by 3 is 32. 100 plus 32 is 132. See? Monster sums, chopped down to size — that's proper mathematician thinking.

■ Say: "Number 64" — Front-End First

Quick one — what's 256 divided by 8? ... If that popped out in under ten seconds, you're already ahead of the game. If not, no stress at all — this trick will sort it. Mental division is easiest from left to right. First ask: about how many tens of the divisor fit? Then deal with whatever's left over. Let's do 256 divided by 8. How many tens? Well, 8 times 30 is 240, and that fits. So the answer starts with 30-something. Now what's left: 256 minus 240 is 16. And 16 divided by 8 is 2. Put them together: 30 plus 2 is 32. So 256 divided by 8 is 32. Your turn — pause me if you need to: what's 192 divided by 6? ... and what's 144 divided by 4? ... Have a proper go before I tell you... Right, let's check. 192 divided by 6: 6 times 30 is 180 — that fits. 192 minus 180 is 12, and 12 divided by 6 is 2. So 30 plus 2 is 32. Now 144 divided by 4: 4 times 30 is 120. 144 minus 120 is 24, and 24 divided by 4 is 6. So 30 plus 6 is 36. See? Big divisions, tamed. Go smash the practice.

■ Say: "Number 65" — Subtract Friendly Chunks

Here's a chunky one — what's 432 divided by 6? ... If you cracked that in under ten seconds, hats off, you barely need me. If not, brilliant — you're about to learn a lovely trick. You build the answer up by subtracting easy multiples of the divisor, starting big. Each time, keep note of how many lots you took. At the end, add up all your friendly multipliers. Let's do 432 divided by 6. Start big: 6 times 50 is 300. Take it off: 432 minus 300 is 132. Next: 6 times 20 is 120. Take it off: 132 minus 120 is 12. Then 6 times 2 is 12. Take it off: 12 minus 12 is 0. Now add the multipliers: 50 plus 20 plus 2 is 72. So 432 divided by 6 is 72. Your turn — pause me if you need to: what's 345 divided by 5? ... and what's 288 divided by 4? ... Give it a real go first... Checking time. 345 divided by 5: 5 times 50 is 250, and 345 minus 250 is 95. 5 times 10 is 50, and 95 minus 50 is 45. 5 times 9 is 45, leaving 0. Add them: 50 plus 10 plus 9 is 69. And 288 divided by 4: 4 times 50 is 200, leaving 88. 4 times 20 is 80, leaving 8. 4 times 2 is 8, leaving 0. So 50 plus 20 plus 2 is 72. That's it — chunk by chunk, you can divide anything.

■ Say: "Number 66" — Round to Estimate

Quick one — roughly what's 347 divided by 6? Not exactly — just roughly. ... If you said about 60 within ten seconds, you already think like a mathematician. If not, don't worry — this is one of the most useful habits in all of maths. When the numbers are awkward, round them to something tidier before you start. Pick a nearby number that divides cleanly, and you'll instantly know the size of the answer — which stops silly mistakes. Let's do 347 divided by 6. 347 is awkward, but 360 is a multiple of 6, and it's nearby. 360 divided by 6 is 60. So 347 divided by 6 is about 60 — a bit less, actually, since 347 is a bit under 360. Your turn — pause me if you need to: roughly what's 415 divided by 7? ... and roughly what's 251 divided by 5? ... Have a proper think before I tell you... Let's check together. 415 divided by 7: round 415 up to 420, because 420 divided by 7 is 60. So the answer is about 60. And 251 divided by 5: round 251 down to 250, and 250 divided by 5 is 50. So it's just over 50. Always estimate before a big division — you'll spot a wrong answer a mile off. You've got this one.

■ Say: "Number 67" — The 11 Test

Tricky one — does 2915 divide exactly by 11? ... If you knew that in under ten seconds, you might be part calculator. If not, perfect — this trick feels like actual magic. To test for 11, you add and subtract the digits alternately: plus, minus, plus, minus. If the answer is 0 or any multiple of 11, the number divides by 11. Let's test 2915. The digits are 2, 9, 1, 5. Go alternately: 2 minus 9 is minus 7 ... plus 1 is minus 6 ... minus 5 is minus 11. Minus 11 is a multiple of 11 — so yes! 2915 divides by 11 exactly: it's 11 times 265. Your turn — pause me if you need to: does 253 divide by 11? ... and does 175 divide by 11? ... Have a proper go with the plus-minus pattern... Let's check. For 253: 2 minus 5 is minus 3, plus 3 is 0. Zero counts — so yes, 253 divides by 11. It's 11 times 23. For 175: 1 minus 7 is minus 6, plus 5 is minus 1. Minus 1 is not a multiple of 11 — so no, 175 does not divide by 11. See? You've just learned a test most grown-ups have never even heard of.

■ Say: "Number 68" — The 7 Trick

Here's a sneaky one — does 364 divide exactly by 7? ... If you spotted that in under ten seconds, your 7 times table is in great shape. If not, no worries — there's a secret test for sevens. Take the last digit, double it, and subtract that from the rest of the number. If what's left divides by 7, so does the whole number. Let's test 364.

The last digit is 4, and double 4 is 8. The rest of the number is 36. Now 36 minus 8 is 28 — and 28 divided by 7 is 4, so yes! 364 divides by 7. In fact, 364 divided by 7 is 52. Your turn — pause me if you need to: does 315 divide by 7? ... and does 249 divide by 7? ... Try the double-and-subtract test before I tell you... Let's check. For 315: last digit 5, double it to get 10. The rest is 31, and 31 minus 10 is 21. 21 divided by 7 is 3 — so yes, 315 divides by 7. It's 7 times 45. For 249: last digit 9, double it to get 18. The rest is 24, and 24 minus 18 is 6. And 6 doesn't divide by 7 — so no, 249 does not divide by 7. That's it — you now carry a seven-detector in your head.

Done with this part? Save the audio into OneDrive > Times tables > recordings. Thank you!